

EXAMINED

Garmin fēnix 3 HR

The Fenix 3 HR, albeit a generation old now, still packs more than what most wearables have - and it does it well. Priced at ₹53k, it sure comes off as a bit heavy on your pockets but this is, in all ways, one activity tracker to rule them all. Along with standard features like step and sleep tracking, every activity from swimming, hiking, rowing and more is available in the form of 'apps' that you can install or remove using the companion app Garmin Connect. On top of that, you get the standard suite of 'smart' features like notifications and alarms. You can even open certain notifications for a basic textual preview of the content, and accept calls.

The watch boasts a huge array of sensors, which allows the device to offer advanced features like GPS based speed and distance tracking, auto lap, vertical oscillation and ratio (while running), shot distance (for golf), competing against previous courses (cycling), swim efficiency and many more activity specific features. A recurring issue, though, was that the watch kept disconnecting from the phone quite frequently. Apart from this one hitch, the watch offers exactly what it promises - which is a lot compared to the competition.

The fitness conscious geeks that we are, we took the Garmin Fenix 3 HR for a test dive at the pool. It was fairly decent at detecting number of laps, however when idling at the shallow end during rest periods, often its algorithms would add a false lap now and then. Once the swim data was synced with the app, whole new levels of insights were revealed. You are able to drill down to see your overall as well as specific average pace,



max pace, distance per swim etc for a particular run. And it is all presented to you in a very easy to use companion app.

Overall, if you are in the habit of multiple types of workouts and activities on a regular basis, this is definitely the best activity tracker that you can get for your money - albeit a lot of it.

Price: ₹52,999/-

SPECIFICATIONS

PHYSICAL DIMENSIONS: 2.0" x 2.0" x 0.6" (51.5 x 51.5 x 16.0 mm) | **DISPLAY SIZE:** WxH-1.2" (30.4 mm) diameter | **DISPLAY RESOLUTION:** WxH-218 x 218 pixels; transfective MIP color; sapphire lens | **WEIGHT WITH SILICONE BAND:** 3.0 oz (86.1 g) | **BATTERY:** Rechargeable 300mAh lithium-ion

Speedo V-Class Vue

Speedo decided to send us their new V-Class goggle this month and boy were we impressed. Not particularly accustomed to physical exertion, normally we'd be reluctant to try out anything that required us test real world physics and graphics; but not this piece of tech-infused sporting equipment. The goggle boasts 2 x anti-fog technology and features a clear lens that offers an expansive underwater view. The V-Class was developed in Aqualab (Speedo's specialist R&D department)



and won this year's Red Dot Award for Design & Innovation. It's very comfortable, even with prolonged usage and the visibility it offers is far better than our trusty Futura (which was waiting for an upgrade anyway).

Price: ₹4,499